# General Dessert #6: CW Operating Procedures

**Full break-in (QSK), prosigns, Q signals, zero-beating, the RST report, and matching speed when answering a CQ.**

**Group G2C · 11 pool questions · Self-study reference · Practice exams at eham.net/exams**

## Key Facts Reference

### CW Operating Practice

| Question | Answer | Q |
|---|---|---|
| Full break-in CW (QSK) means | **Transmitting stations can receive between code characters and elements.** | G2C01 |
| Best speed to answer a CQ in Morse | **The fastest speed at which you are comfortable copying, but no faster than the CQ.** | G2C05 |
| What “zero beat” means in CW operation | **Matching the transmit frequency to the frequency of a received signal.** | G2C06 |
| “C” appended to an RST report | **Chirpy or unstable signal.** | G2C07 |

### Prosigns

| Prosign / signal | Meaning | Q |
|---|---|---|
| **KN** at end of a transmission | Listening only for a specific station or stations. | G2C03 |
| **AR** | End of a formal message. | G2C08 |

### Q Signals

| Q signal | Meaning | Q |
|---|---|---|
| **QRS?** (response) | **Send slower.** | G2C02 |
| **QRL?** | **“Are you busy?” / “Is this frequency in use?”** | G2C04 |
| **QSL** | **I have received and understood.** | G2C09 |
| **QRN** | **I am troubled by static.** | G2C10 |
| **QRV** | **I am ready to receive.** | G2C11 |

# Dessert 6 Question Bank (G2C)

**G2C01.** Which of the following describes full break-in CW operation (QSK)?
A. Breaking stations send the Morse code prosign “BK”
B. Automatic keyers, instead of hand keys, are used to send Morse code
C. An operator must activate a manual send/receive switch before and after every transmission
D. Transmitting stations can receive between code characters and elements

**G2C02.** What should you do if a CW station sends “QRS?”
A. Send slower
B. Change frequency
C. Increase your power
D. Repeat everything twice

**G2C03.** What does it mean when a CW operator sends “KN” at the end of a transmission?
A. No US stations should call
B. Operating full break-in
C. Listening only for a specific station or stations
D. Closing station now

**G2C04.** What does the Q signal “QRL?” mean?
A. “Will you keep the frequency clear?”
B. “Are you operating full break-in?” or “Can you operate full break-in?”
C. “Are you listening only for a specific station?”
D. “Are you busy?” or “Is this frequency in use?”

**G2C05.** What is the best speed to use when answering a CQ in Morse code?
A. The fastest speed at which you are comfortable copying, but no slower than the CQ
B. The fastest speed at which you are comfortable copying, but no faster than the CQ
C. At the standard calling speed of 10 wpm
D. At the standard calling speed of 5 wpm

**G2C06.** What does the term “zero beat” mean in CW operation?
A. Matching the speed of the transmitting station
B. Operating split to avoid interference on frequency
C. Sending without error
D. Matching the transmit frequency to the frequency of a received signal

**G2C07.** When sending CW, what does a “C” mean when added to the RST report?
A. Chirpy or unstable signal
B. Report was read from an S meter rather than estimated
C. 100 percent copy
D. Key clicks

**G2C08.** What prosign is sent to indicate the end of a formal message when using CW?
A. SK
B. BK
C. AR
D. KN

**G2C09.** What does the Q signal “QSL” mean?
A. Send slower
B. We have already confirmed the contact
C. I have received and understood
D. We have worked before

**G2C10.** What does the Q signal “QRN” mean?
A. Send more slowly
B. Stop sending
C. Zero beat my signal
D. I am troubled by static

**G2C11.** What does the Q signal “QRV” mean?
A. You are sending too fast
B. There is interference on the frequency
C. I am quitting for the day
D. I am ready to receive

**Answer Key**

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| G2C01: D | G2C02: A | G2C03: C | G2C04: D |
| G2C05: B | G2C06: D | G2C07: A | G2C08: C |
| G2C09: C | G2C10: D | G2C11: D | |